

Cadence Design Systems

Computational Engineering — Multiphysics / CFD / Simulation · San Jose, CA · NASDAQ: CDNS (~+17% rev growth FY26; ~\$80B+ cap)

Cadence - now owner of Hexagon's CFD/structural engineering stack and a Physical-AI/NVIDIA partner - has never been in motorsport, and computational simulation is the literal toolchain an F1 team designs its car with.

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OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW

WARM

SERIES

F1

RECOMMENDED TEAM

Cadillac F1 Team

ACTION HORIZON

8-12 WKS

THE CASE

Cadence Design Systems, long the leader in chip design, has become a computational-engineering powerhouse: in Feb 2026 it completed the acquisition of Hexagon's Design & Engineering business (MSC Nastran, Adams), combining structural, acoustics and multibody dynamics with its own multiphysics and CFD portfolio, and it raised FY26 growth guidance to ~17% (an NVIDIA 'Physical AI' partner). It has never entered motorsport. The fit is literal and on-profile (deep-tech, public): F1 performance is won in simulation - aerodynamics (CFD under the cost cap), vehicle dynamics and structural analysis - which is exactly Cadence's post-Hexagon stack. Cadillac, the greenfield 2026 team, must build its entire CAE/simulation capability from zero, so the lane is cleanly open. Verified decision path: SVP Marketing & Business Development Nimish Modi (sponsorship owner) and President & CEO Anirudh Devgan (C-level sponsor), with the System Design & Analysis (multiphysics) organisation as technical counterpart.

WHY NOW

Cadence just expanded into the full multiphysics/CFD/structural stack and is investing in brand around 'Physical AI', so capital and appetite align now. F1's 2026 rules raise the simulation premium (lighter cars, active aero, electrical-heavy power units), and greenfield Cadillac is choosing its engineering tooling today - get in before the stack is set, not after.

PROOF POINTS — EVERY FIGURE VERIFIED TO A PRIMARY SOURCE (SEE P.2)

multiphysics

Completed Hexagon Design & Engineering acquisition (Feb 2026; CFD/structural/multibody)

~17%

FY26 revenue growth guidance (raised)

Anirudh Devgan

President & CEO (since 2021; C-level sponsor)

Nimish Modi

SVP Marketing & Business Development (decision-maker)

Honda

Customer using Cadence CFD for full-engine simulation

GRID FIT — CATEGORY-WHITESPACE CHECK ACROSS THE F1 GRID (1440 TEAM-FIT ENGINE)

Cadillac	PRIME LANE	greenfield entry — partner roster being built from zero
McLaren	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Red Bull Racing	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Williams	OPEN	no rival in this category lane

BOTTOM LINE

After acquiring Hexagon's design-and-engineering business (CFD, structural, multibody - MSC Nastran, Adams), Cadence now owns the full multiphysics/CFD/CAE stack that an F1 team designs its car with. A real, deep MODE-A workstream, raised FY26 guidance, NVIDIA-partnered 'Physical AI'. Greenfield Cadillac must build its entire simulation stack from zero - the cleanest open lane. Decision-maker: SVP Marketing & BD Nimish Modi.

NEVER ENTERED

FUNDING EVENT

CATEGORY WHITESPACE

DISCOVERY: SELF

1440 SPORTS · LONDON

CADENCE DESIGN SYSTEMS · 19 JUN 2026

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WHY CADILLAC F1 TEAM

Cadillac is the only greenfield 2026 team, building its CAE/simulation capability from scratch - so Cadence can architect the design toolchain from day one, a uniquely concrete workstream - and the simulation lane is open (IFS = ERP, TWG = AI, Tenneco = powertrain). (Per signals-not-placements, other 1440 signals aimed at Cadillac in different categories do not occupy the simulation lane.)

VALUE TO CADILLAC F1 TEAM — MODE A (TECH IN THE CAR / CHAMPIONSHIP)

MODE A, real mechanics. (1) TECHNICAL (the core): aero, vehicle dynamics and structural performance are decided in simulation, and Cadence's post-Hexagon multiphysics/CFD/structural stack (incl. MSC Nastran, Adams) is exactly that toolchain - for greenfield Cadillac, Cadence can stand up the design-and-simulation environment from day one and co-engineer it, a flagship 'the simulation that designs the car' reference, not signage. (2) COMMERCIAL / B2B: Cadence sells to every engineering and semiconductor enterprise, and the F1 paddock is full of those technical buyers - hospitality becomes a pipeline, while Cadillac gains a deep-pocketed (~\$80B+) engineering-software anchor. (3) BRAND / TALENT: 'Physical AI designs the car' is an ownable narrative on a data-driven sport, with a simulation/engineering-talent halo. Cadillac gets its design backbone; Cadence gets a live, visible reference.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Official Simulation / Computational-Engineering Partner on the Cadillac F1 Team, minimum three years, ~\$4-6M/yr, with category exclusivity in multiphysics/CFD/CAE and a co-engineered design-and-simulation deployment.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Nimish Modi
SVP, MARKETING & BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT, CADENCE - VERIFIED

Senior VP of Marketing & Business Development - owns brand and partnership development, the right entry point. Decision path: Modi (brand/BD) -> President & CEO Anirudh Devgan (C-level sponsor) -> the System Design & Analysis (multiphysics) leadership as technical counterpart.

OPENING ANGLE

"Nimish - F1 is won in simulation, and you now own the full CFD/multiphysics stack. Cadillac is building its design environment from zero - Cadence could architect it. 'Physical AI designs the car', a real workstream. 25 minutes?"

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING 16 / 20 Just completed the Hexagon D&E acquisition (Feb 2026, + \$160M to FY26) and raised FY26 growth guidance to ~17% - a fresh, expanded multiphysics stack and a brand-investment window.	CAPACITY 17 / 20 ~\$80B+ market cap with double-digit growth across every segment - easily funds a multi-year partnership.	BRAND FIT 16 / 20 CFD/multiphysics is the literal toolchain of F1 car design; the lane is open on greenfield Cadillac, which is building its CAE capability from scratch.	URGENCY 13 / 20 The Physical-AI/engineering-simulation cycle is hot and Cadillac is making its tooling decisions now, but no single dated trigger.	OPS FIT 17 / 20 MODE A: aerodynamics (CFD under the cost cap), vehicle dynamics and structural analysis are won or lost in simulation - exactly Cadence's post-Hexagon multiphysics stack.
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RISKS & COUNTERS

CAE INCUMBENTS Established teams already run Ansys/Siemens internally. **Counter:** Cadillac is greenfield with no incumbent CAE sponsor, so the lane is genuinely open - architect from day one rather than displace.

B2B-SOFTWARE BRAND LOGIC Cadence sells to engineers, not consumers. **Counter:** F1 is full of B2B engineering-software partners; the paddock is Cadence's buyer base and the design workstream carries the logic.

GREENFIELD-TEAM TIMING A new team's tooling decisions are in flux. **Counter:** That flux is the opportunity - engage now while the stack is being chosen, with phased deployment.

SOURCES

- https://www.cadence.com/en_US/home/company/newsroom/press-releases/pr/2026/cadence-completes-acquisition-of-hexagons-design-and-engineering.html
- <https://www.tikr.com/blog/cadence-design-systems-stock-q1-2026-earnings-every-segment-grew-double-digits>
- <https://theorg.com/org/cadence-design-systems/org-chart/anirudh-devgan>
- https://www.cadence.com/en_US/home/company/leadership-team.html